QUOTING, PARAPHRASING, AND SUMMARISING

Quoting, paraphrasing, and summarising are all different ways of including the ideas of others in your writing. Quoting a passage allows you to share the exact words and phrases of another author, while paraphrasing and summarising allow you to present another author's ideas in your own words. Either way, referring to secondary sources makes your own ideas and your paper more credible. Also, properly quoting, paraphrasing, and summarising are great ways to avoid plagiarism.

What are the differences?

Quoting
- Involves copying short passages from the original text word-for-word
- Places copied words within quotation marks ("…")
- Includes an in-text citation in the expected style (e.g. APA, MLA, IEEE, etc.)

Paraphrasing
- Involves putting a section of a text into your own words
- Changes the words and phrasing of the original text, but keeps the meaning of the original text
- Includes an in-text citation in the expected style

Summarising
- Involves stating the main ideas and findings of a text in your own words
- Presents a general overview, so is usually much shorter than the original text
- Includes an in-text citation in the expected style

Quoting

Quoting is when you repeat an author's work word-for-word. Direct quotes are placed within quotation marks ("…") and are cited using an in-text citation using the expected citation style (e.g. APA, MLA, etc.). For example, an APA-formatted citation would look like this:

- "The systematic development of literacy and schooling meant a new division in society, between the educated and the uneducated" (Cook-Gumperz, 1986, p. 27).

If you are quoting longer passages (more than 40 words), please see the Assignment Style Sheet.

Use a Quote
- When the author's exact words convey the meaning in a powerful way
- When you cannot possibly say the information any better
- To introduce an author's position that you want to discuss
- To support claims in your writing or provide evidence for the points you are making

How to Quote
If you want to include a quotation in your writing, make sure to introduce, cite, and explain the quotation. This technique is known as the ICE method.

Introduce
Introduce quotes by stating the author's last name, any necessary background information, and a signal verb. According to APA guidelines, signal verbs should be written in the past tense, while in MLA, signal verbs should be present tense. For example (in APA):

- As stated by McCarthy in his 2006 novel *The Road*: "You forget what you want to remember, and you remember what you want to forget" (p. 12).

Cite
Provide in-text citations in the expected style for all quotes. Place every quotation between quotation marks ("…") and copy the text word-for-word, including the text's original punctuation and capital letters.

Explain
Make sure to explain your quotations. Describe why this quotation is important, or comment on the relevance of the quotation. To help with your explanation, ask yourself the following questions:

- What is this quote saying?
- How does this information add to what I am trying to prove in this paragraph?
- Why is it relevant to what I am saying? What is its significance?
- What am I trying to show or prove with this information?

Never leave any room for interpretation. It is your responsibility as the writer to explain the quoted information for your reader.

Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing is when you use your own words to express someone else's ideas. When you paraphrase, you keep the same meaning of the original text, but you use different words and phrasing to convey that meaning, and you cite the information using an in-text citation in the expected style (e.g. APA, MLA, etc.). For example:

Original paragraph from Nancy Woloch's book, *Women and the American Experience: A Concise History*:

> "The feminization of clerical work and teaching by the turn of the century reflected the growth of business and public education. It also reflected limited opportunities elsewhere. Throughout the nineteenth century, stereotyping of work by sex had restricted women's employment. Job options were limited; any field that admitted women attracted a surplus of applicants willing to work for less pay than men would have received. The entry of women into such fields – whether grammar school teaching or office work – drove down wages."

Paraphrased version (using an APA in-text citation):

> According to Nancy Woloch (2002) in *Women and the American Experience: A Concise History*, the "feminization" of jobs in the nineteenth century had two major effects: a lack of employment options for women and inadequate compensation for positions that were available. Thus, while an abundance of clerical and teaching jobs indicated a boom in these sectors, since there were few alternatives, women accepted less pay than male workers would have been paid (p. 170).

Use Paraphrasing

- As an option to quoting
- To rewrite someone else's ideas without changing the meaning
- To express someone else's ideas in your own words
- To support claims in your writing

How to Paraphrase

- Read the text carefully. Be sure you understand the text fully.
- Put the original text aside and write your paraphrase in your own words. Consider each point of the original text, and how you could rephrase it. Do not simply replace every third or fourth word of the original passage.
- Review your paraphrase and make sure that it reflects the meaning of the original text but is in your own words and style. Include all the main points and essential information.
- Include an in-text citation in the expected style (e.g. APA, MLA, etc.).
- Explain why the paraphrased information is important. To do so, ask yourself the following questions:
    - What am I trying to show or prove with this information?
    - Why is it relevant to what I am saying? What is its significance?
    - How does this information add to what I am trying to prove in this paragraph?

Summarising

A summary is a shortened version of a longer text. In your summary, you state the main idea in your own words, but specific examples and details are left out.

Use a Summary

- When a passage from a source is too long to quote or paraphrase
- When only the main ideas of a source are relevant to your paper
- When the details in a text might distract, overwhelm, or confuse readers

How to Summarise

- Start by reading the text and highlighting the main points as you read.
- Reread the text and make notes of the main points, leaving out examples, evidence, etc.
- Without looking at the original text, rewrite your notes in your own words. State the main idea of the passage at the beginning of your summary plus all major points. Consider including the main findings and/or the conclusion of the original text.
- Include an in-text citation in the expected style (e.g. APA, MLA, etc.).

Adapted from:

Zovio. (2019). Quoting, paraphrasing, & summarizing. Retrieved 19 June 2020 from https://writingcenter.ashford.edu/quoting-paraphrasing-summarizing